

Medicines during disrupted services

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QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Keep essential medicines, a written medication list and the supplies needed to administer them accessible. Follow each product's storage instructions and protect medicines from floodwater, freezing and excess heat. Contact a pharmacist or clinician for a product-specific shortage or storage problem; do not change doses or substitute medicines on your own.

Do now.

- ☐ **Write the essential list**
01 Record the medicine name, strength, usual dose, prescriber, pharmacy and allergies. Keep a paper copy with the medicine and a copy with a trusted contact.
- ☐ **Count usable supply**
02 Track what remains and identify which medicine interruption is most urgent. Include inhalers, needles, testing supplies and batteries, not just tablets.
- ☐ **Protect storage**
03 Use the product label and pharmacist advice for temperature limits. Avoid direct heat and sunlight; do not let temperature-sensitive medicines freeze against ice packs.
- ☐ **Contact alternatives early**
04 Try a reachable pharmacy, clinician or verified medical aid provider before the supply is exhausted. Ask about the exact product; replacement rules vary.
- ☐ **Keep treatment unchanged unless advised**
05 Do not ration by skipping or doubling doses without professional direction. Seek urgent medical help for deterioration rather than trying an unverified substitute.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use the written list to seek qualified advice through a reachable pharmacy or verified clinic. Preserve safe storage and track supply. If a life-critical treatment cannot be maintained, prioritise relocation to care before the last dose or battery is used.

Watch for.

A medicine can be unsafe after heat or flood exposure even when its package looks normal. Product-specific advice matters; there is no universal safe unrefrigerated storage period.

People & practical needs.

Write names, strengths, schedules, allergies, prescriber and pharmacy contacts and any storage needs. Keep that information private and accessible to a trusted caregiver

Next decision.

Before a disruption, agree a refill and storage plan with the prescriber or pharmacist, within local rules. If you use insulin or powered equipment, keep its specific emergency instructions with the kit.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

FDA · Keeping medications safe in emergencies

CDC · Diabetes care during emergencies

FDA – Insulin storage during an emergency

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/medication-continuity/>